

EXAMINED

Rapoo VPRO V600

Rapoo's foray into the gaming peripherals segment hasn't gone unnoticed. We've checked out some of their gaming keyboards and gaming mice, and upon hearing about their gaming controller, we got our hands on the V600. Superficially, the VPRO V600 is very much similar to the XBOX 360 controller and features the exact same layout. This adds a level of familiarity that makes the transition to the V600 seamless. In fact, the V600 takes it up a notch by supporting multiple modes. You can use the Xinput, DirectInput and Android compatible modes to plug this controller into any of the most popular Windows game titles. The irksome thing about the V600 is that the manual is only in



Simplified Chinese, so if you wanted to get an understanding of the device, you'd either have to spend an inordinate amount of time experimenting with it or an equally long period trying to use Google Translate to get all your answers.

Functionally, the V600 plays really well. The analog input is very responsive and well-zeroed. We can't say that they'll remain that way after an extended period of time since the product does not mention any MTBF period. Rapoo's pricing for the V600 stands at ₹2,999 which is way more than the Xbox 360's wired and wireless controllers. While both support Xinput making them virtually the same with regards to features, the Xbox 360 controller simply ends up getting picked over the V600. The redeeming feature for the V600 is its support for Android Gamepad supported games which if you were to use an Xbox 360 controller, would require an extra step.

PRICE: ₹2,999

5D+ CARDZ from Red Chimpz

Since augmented reality broke into the scene, there have been many speculations regarding its applications, with education being a highly talked about field in this respect. 5D+ Cardz from Red Chimpz is an interesting product aimed at that particular spot of AR based educational tools. Available in four sets of Wild Animals, Aquatic Animals, Insects and Birds, the product comes as a set of 16 unique cards and a couple of other cards. You need to install the 5D+ AR VR CARDZ app from Play Store (<http://dgit.in/5DARVR>) or the app store and scan the theme cards to download that particular package to your phone. Once you have done that, you can scan any of the cards in the set to see that creature materialise, animated and creating sound, right on the card. The best part is, it moves around the environment. You can scan more than one card and the creatures will move around each other. Different



sets create different environments for the AR creatures to move in. There's also a surprise card, which, if scanned, brings to life a random creature that you can move around by dragging it on the screen. The app offers a VR mode where the view goes into split screen mode. You can put your phone into any of the VR headsets that support phones to see the AR creatures in VR. You can take pictures of the creatures in the AR mode. Additionally, if you're using the front camera of your smartphone for the AR bit, you can even take selfies with the AR creatures.

The cards themselves have a few interesting facts about the creatures on the back and come with a handy ring to keep them together. This is a really useful gift for a kid, one that's way more interactive than traditional toys and hence more efficient in making them learn something helpful. Apart from some persistent AR glitches, where the creatures move around with your phone screen rather than staying on the card, this is a really interesting gift for the young ones around you.

PRICE: ₹499/- per set, **APP:** Free

